

Barnsley FC Fan Advisory Group Meeting Minutes			
Date of Meeting	Thursday 16 th January 2025		
Location	Rimmington Lounge, Oakwell Stadium		
Time	6:30 pm		
Meeting Objective(s)			
Attendance			
Present		Apologies	
John Bird - JB	Kelly Drury - KD	Clair Calton - CC	
Jon Flatman - JF	Curtis Ledger - CL	Dominic Wood – DW	
Robin Harris – RH (<i>Minutes</i>)		Steve Brain - SB	
Phil Hall - PH			
Martin Wilson – MW			
Andy Gaskell – AG			
Heather Linney – HL (<i>Late</i>)			
Agenda, Discussions, Issues			
Topic / Discussion Notes			Discussion led by
Chair’s Welcome			KD
KD welcomed everyone to the meeting.			
Agenda Item 1. – Updates and Actions from the previous minutes.			KD
December 2024 minutes have not yet been circulated and reviewed. KD is to circulate these to JF to approve and then to group for approval and publishing. As such, there was no discussion on previous action points.			Action Log Agenda Item 1: KD to circulate Dec 24’ minutes to group and JF for approval and publishing.
Agenda Item 2. – FAB Contacts/Liaison			CL
CL raised a point around potentially meeting with other, similar groups to the Barnsley FAB to build a contact network. It was discussed that it would be a fantastic opportunity to help learn and found out more about other’s experiences within similar roles. JF noted that clubs such as Lincoln have a well-established FAB and would be happy to help contact them for a starting point. KD mentioned the possibility of a future conference for the boards, which was positively regarded by the group.			Action Log Agenda Item 2: CL to begin research and contacting similar groups in the league. CL will also liaise with JF around the Lincoln FAB and other groups.
Agenda Item 3. – Car Parking.			HL
HL began discussions by briefing the group on her meeting with DW before the last home game to talk more about car parking in the Oakwell area. It has been previously mentioned regarding safety concerns around fans and cars leaving at similar times after home games on Belgrave Road. They also found similar issues on Grasmere and other roads. It was noted that DW had mentioned the issues of cones, and that while they are there for a reason, fans do not respect these and move, take or damage these. HL and DW are currently looking into what can be done in the future regarding the residents and preventing public parking and unsafe release during games. HL has			No Specific Actions for the log recorded on Agenda Item 3.

been made aware to an ongoing court case in London and will look into this to see if there are any possibilities to implement similar actions down here. It was raised that residents are concerned about emergency vehicles being unable to gain access after the roads are closed at 2:30, but it was confirmed by several members of the group this is not the case and emergency vehicles will be allowed access if and when needed.	
Agenda Item 4 – Transport for Fans	HL
HL brought to the groups’ attention an elderly fan who was unable to attend the game on New Years Day since public transport did not run, and the fan relied on this to get to and from games. HL offered to pick up and drop the fan off but wanted to use the opportunity to potentially offer a service for fans on days like this. A rich group discussion followed, and it was noted by JF that this would be an opportunity for the board to lobby with local travel authority regarding specific matchday busses on days where public transport may not run. CL also mentioned an opportunity around encouraging carsharing within the club. This was not discussed further.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 4.
Agenda Item 5. – Teddy Toss	HL
HL presented the idea of a “Teddy Toss” to the group. There were examples of other UK clubs and foreign clubs having such an event, and it was believed this would be a great opportunity for a charitable donation. A positive group discussion followed, where RH noted that a similar thing is done by UK ice hockey teams after the first goal, but questioned what may be the logistics of it done at a football team. A range of ideas were shared, from a pre-game toss to the potential of doing it on the yearly open day. JF welcomed the idea but has also noted it would need to be discussed further with the Stadium Safety Manager.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 5.
Agenda Item 6. – Train Tickets Sale	AG
No discussion was had on this agenda item as it will be actioned in relation to agenda point 8.	No specific action noted for Agenda Item 6 as will be resolved through Action Log Agenda Item 8: AG to use this agenda point as a test for the “News” section on the FAB website.
Agenda Item 7 – Toilet Access	MW
MW raised the question if fans can access the disabled stand and the toilets in there while queuing for the box office. JB confirmed that if a fan had the necessary requirements, that a member of staff would be happy to take the fan through to use the toilet. He also made aware that the stand would open at 12 on a matchday, and as such stewards would be happy to take a fan through for use.	No Specific Action noted for Agenda Item 7.
Agenda Item 8 – FAB Website	PG
PG gave a presentation on the website he has for the Fan Advisory Board. He toured the group around the site, showing all the sections of the website from the “About Us” section to the news section. He showed the potential of the website and how we as a group can use the website to update the fans about our meetings	Action Log Agenda Item 8: PG is to publish the website formally and will

(through the meetings tab on the site) and through the “News” section where we can publish our actions from meetings and big updates. PG also noted that he has followed guidelines for accessibility to make the website open and available to all. AG noted there may be a potential issue with this, in that there is potential for the group to just publish an article without prior checks. The group then discussed ideas around how this could be prevented, including a holding area in the page for approval from both a chair and the club. CL also raised the point that there should be a small note that minutes are delayed for upload due to group approval, this was agreed upon by the group. JB also said that the website would be freely linked to the main club page for easy access to the fans.	allow board members to test the site first before public use. AG is to use his agenda point 6 as a test for the website before it goes live.
Agenda Item 9. – Crowd Surfer Funding	RH
RH pointed out the current ongoing funding for the crowd surfer from fan groups. JF then briefed the group that this was an idea at the end of 2024, having had the same fan group come down and measure up. The club then offered to pay for the flag, however the idea never got any traction. Now, the idea is up and running, the club once again offered their support to front load funding, however this was politely turned down by the group and with good reason. Club are fully supportive of the initiative. There was also a spirited discussion on images and what is and is not appropriate. The group discussed certain designs and understood there are regulations and guidelines to be followed.	No Specific Action logged for Agenda Item 9.
Agenda Item 10 – Ground Housekeeping.	MW
MW has noted that he has a fan contact him regarding ground untidiness. The fan commented on the corner between the East Stand and South Stand being untidy with rubbish and looking unkept, and also that the netting on the away end is dirty. JF replied that this corner in question has recently had a new paint job, and also noted that strong winds prior to the previous game has blown a lot of rubbish around the ground. JF did recognise he was unsure on the away netting, and logged he would go away and look into this. He would also follow up on the discussed corner.	Action Log Agenda Item 10: JF to look into the away netting and the tidiness of the ground.
Agenda Item 11 – Local Residents’ Chronicle Article	BFC
JF has noted his frustration and disappointment at the actions of the individual which led to a story being run in the local newspaper. He was particularly disappointed around the club’s work being overshadowed by this article. He noted that the club has since responded in an appropriate manner to the resident.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 11.
Agenda Item 12 – 2025/26 Season Tickets	BFC
JF and JB has announced the club are currently in the process of setting the prices for next seasons’ season tickets. It was acknowledged that there is a tight deadline for these, so the FAB may meet early to discuss and approve pricing early. MW asked if there will be Saturday only season tickets. JB confirmed this is not the case, however the Flexi tickets will still be offered, and these will now be the same cost per game as the half season ticket. KD asked if there will be an instalment plan as there was this season. JB confirmed this is the case, with the 10 and 4 month plans being offered along with the addition of a 6 month plan being discussed.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 12.

Agenda Item 13 – Capex Update	BFC
JF confirmed there are formal plans for a 1200 square metre plot in the East Stand Car Park for the incoming Fanzone, with potential for installation towards the last home game of the season, subject to plans being submitted. He also confirmed that there are ongoing works to the fire alarm system. Future plans include work on the East Stand cladding, subject to planning permissions, and Hospitality/concourse upgrades. HL asked regarding safe standing and its installation. JF has clarified that current plans are to install safe standing after the Huddersfield home game; however the club are still awaiting full SGSA sign off. AG inquired if there may be an opportunity to extend the safe standing into OR2, if the implementation in OR1 goes well. JF acknowledged that there would be a possibility of an extension, however we will monitor the OR1 installation and use that as a guide for future expansion. KD asked for an update on the West Stand guttering. JF verified this is to be completed in the summer.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 13.
Agenda Item 14 – Chanting Incidents	BFC
JF highlighted two occasions of chanting incidents in recent weeks. The first of these was the chants aimed at James McClean of Wrexham AFC. IT was noted that the “IRA” part of the chant is not the issue, it is the “Pope” part that is the issue, due to it being a protected characteristic under the law. Therefore, this is racist and illegal and has led to police investigation. The second noted incident was the chant regarding JAQ. JF identified that this chant originally started at Peterborough. The chant is highly offensive and contains words which are not acceptable. JB made it clear that the club are working with agents such as the local Police, her game too and with Kick It Out to identify people who are chanting any offensive chants and act on them.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 14
Agenda Item 15 – Family Area	BFC
JB remarked on the Family Excellence’s report regarding the family area’s size and its location. They had noted that the location isn’t and rather out of the way for most families. The current plan is to move the family area to the lower area to allow for room for player meets and other events. They also plan to move the iPads that are in use with it, as these are used regularly. This is in an exploratory phase. HL asked for an update on if there will be any tables and chairs in the upper tier of the East Stand for families. JB said this was currently up for further discussion.	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 15.
Agenda Item 16 – Fan Engagement Report	BFC
JB has said the club is preparing to produce their 6 monthly update on fan engagement. He has asked the board to help produce a joint statement in the coming weeks which was agreed upon by the group.	Action Log Agenda Item 16: JB to contact group in coming weeks regarding producing the statement.
Agenda Item 17 – Any Other Business (AOB)	ALL
SB has drafted a letter to the EFL regarding experiences of fans like MW. This has been seen by KD and will also be seen by MW and JF to be approved and sent. Future	No Specific Actions for the log recorded for Agenda Item 17.

action on this also includes a one-minute-long video of MW discussing his experiences at the grounds to be attached. Following the incident at Exeter City, MW confirmed that they had kindly reimbursed him for his ticket, travel and other expenses. This was related to the audio visual commentary not being available. HL questioned if the 10 mile away team rule imposed by police forces was no longer in force, due to some fan groups heading to Chorley as their stop before heading onto Bolton Wanderers. JF confirmed this was still in force, however there may be exceptions made, which is up to local police. MW asked for an update on the upgraded microphones for the hospital radio commentary team. PH confirmed that DW had purchased and donated the two new microphones. AG provided positive feedback from the fans for this season’s reissued retro shirt, and asked if there would be potential for a fan vote on what the next one should be. JF noted this for discussion with Fanatics. KD asked for further updates on the QR scan system for food and drinks at fan’s seats. JF verified that this is much more difficult, and while there may be a trial by the end of the season, this will be on a very small scale and around half time collections and pre-order.					
Close – 19.55pm					
Action Items					
Action Log			Responsible		Due Date
Action Log Agenda Item 1: KD to circulate Dec 24’ minutes to group and JF for approval and publishing.			KD		February FAB Meeting
Action Log Agenda Item 2: CL to begin research and contacting similar groups in the league. CL will also liaise with JF around the Lincoln FAB and other groups.			CL		February FAB Meeting
Action Log Agenda Item 8: PG is to publish the website formally and will allow board members to test the site first before public use. AG is to use his agenda point 6 as a test for the website before it goes live.			PG/AG		February FAB Meeting
Action Log Agenda Item 10: JF to look into the away netting and the tidiness of the ground.			JF		February FAB Meeting
Action Log Agenda Item 16: JB to contact group in coming weeks regarding producing the statement.			JB		February FAB Meeting
Next Meeting					
Date:	Tues 11.2.25	Time:	6.30 pm	Location:	F2F @ OAKWELL Online Available